

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 5
♥ 9 7 4
♦ Q 10 5
♣ A Q 7 3

♠ 9 2

♥ K Q J 10 6 3

♦ 8 3

♣ 9 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q J 10 6
♥ 8
♦ K J 9 4
♣ J 10 8 5

♠ A K 4 3

♥ A 5 2

♦ A 7 6 2

♣ K 4

West

North

East

South

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

Losers: ♠ 0 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 3 : Total = 4

Wow! Partner opens with a 2-bid and you have all of this?

Don't get carried away, it was a **WEAK** 2-bid. So even though you have 19 points partner has only 6-11. But even though it is possible that the total only comes to 25 you bid the game anyway, figuring that it will probably be at least 26.

South would play 4♥.

Click

North plays 4♥. East leads the ♠Q.

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There are two ways to get rid of one of those ♣ losers. You can lead up to the ♣K, hoping that East holds ♣A, or you can ruff it in dummy.

Suppose you try to combine both chances. Win the ♠K, then play a small ♥ to your hand. Lead a ♣ and play dummy's ♣K. West takes the ♣A and plays another trump which you win in your hand. You play another ♣ but West wins this one also and leads another trump, removing dummy's last hope of ruffing a ♣. Down 1.

Instead you could give up on the idea of leading toward the ♣K and just lead a ♣ from dummy at trick 2. The defenders can win and lead a trump, but you play a second ♣. They win this also but even if they lead a trump you can still ruff your third ♣ in dummy and make the game.

You can see that playing a ♣ from dummy will guarantee the contract.

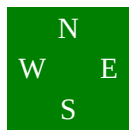
You can also see that leading a ♥ back to your hand at trick 2 is a bad idea.

But did you see there is another way to reach your hand? You could play ♠A then ruff a ♠. This runs the small risk that West started with a singleton ♠.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 2
♥ 8 5 4
♦ A 6 3
♣ 7 5 4 2

♠ A 6
♥ J 9
♦ 10 8 7 4 2
♣ K J 9 3



♠ K J 10 8 4
♥ A K 3 2
♦ 9 5
♣ A 6

♠ 7 5 3
♥ Q 10 7 6
♦ K Q J
♣ Q 10 8

West	North	East	South
		1 ♠	Pass
2 ♠	Pass	3 ♦	Pass
3 ♠			
All Pass			
3 ♠ by East			

Losers: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 5

The ♦ loser, the ♣ loser and the Ace of trumps are unavoidable. One ♥ loser is also unavoidable, but the second one can be ruffed in dummy. You cannot afford to play a single trump.

Win the ♦ A and play ♥ A, ♥ K, ♥ 2. The defenders will win this. If your ♥ 3 happened to set up then you won't have to ruff it, but more than likely the ♥ s split 4-2. The defenders may now take a ♦ winner, or they may lead ♠ A and another ♠. But they cannot stop you from ruffing your fourth ♥ with dummy's ♠ Q or ♠ 9.

The defenders may not lead trumps to try to stop your ruff.

In that case you must be sure to ruff the fourth ♥ with the ♠ Q or the ♠ 9. If North wants to over-ruff it will be with the ♠ A which you must lose anyway.

Look at what would have happened if you had led a trump at trick 2. North could have won the ♠ A and played another ♠. Then, when South took the third ♥ he could lead his last ♠ and dummy would have no trump to ruff the final ♥ with.

With 6 points you must respond. And with 3 ♠ s you can support partner's suit.

You respond 2 ♠ and partner bids 3 ♦.

Partner's 3 ♦ bid is a Help Suit Game Try. He is inviting you to bid game if you have a good 2 ♠ response, particularly if you can help him in ♦ s.

Although have the ♦ help you have a bare minimum response. So you return to 3 ♠ which partner passes.

West would play 3 ♠.

Click

East plays 3 ♠. South leads the ♦ K.

East plays 3 ♠. South leads the ♦ K.